MERRIVALE STATE UNIVERSITY
Center for Transportation Safety | 410 Linden Hall, Kessington

14 April 2027

Janet Brooks
Impaired Driving Program Manager
Governor's Highway Safety Office

Re: Four counties certified high-range for the FY2028 County Impaired Driving Task Force grants

Dear Janet Brooks,

Under section 2.1 of the FY2028 program guidelines, the Center certifies Corwin (0.71 alcohol-impaired-driving fatalities per 100 million vehicle miles, 2023 to 2025), Hatchell (0.68), Ossian (0.68) and Tanager (0.66) as high-range for FY2028. The other ten counties are below 0.60; the nearest is Kittredge, at 0.57.

Tanager is on the list because most of its surviving drivers were never tested. The State Patrol and the Corwin and Ossian sheriffs draw blood from every surviving driver; the county and city agencies draw it only after an arrest at the scene. Where every driver is tested, officers arrested 28.6 per cent of the drivers between .08 and .149 and 88.9 per cent of those at .15 or more, so each arrested driver found at .08 or more elsewhere stands for 3.5 drivers in the lower band and 1.125 in the higher. Tanager's county and city agencies arrested 8 such drivers in the lower band and 8 in the higher, which puts 21.0 impaired surviving drivers there untested.

Four counties at or above 0.60 alcohol-impaired-driving deaths per 100 million vehicle miles, 2023 to 2025

Deaths per 100 million vehicle miles; labels on the high-range counties and the nearest below the line

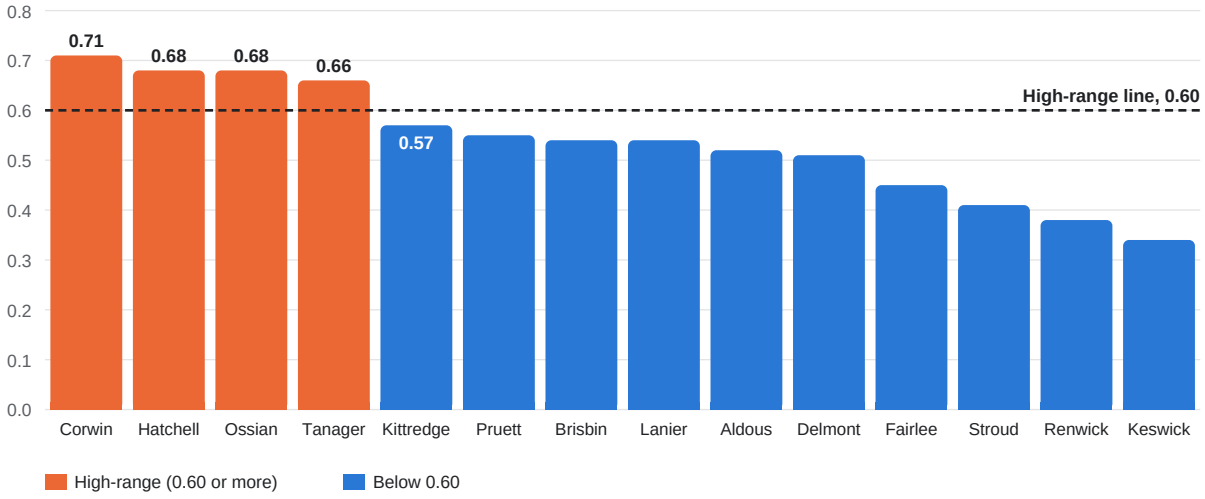


Figure 1. Each county's 2023 to 2025 rate against the 0.60 line (guidelines 2.4); Table 1 gives every county's figures.

Table 1. Rates and 2025 baselines by county

County	Deaths, 2023 to 2025	Vehicle miles (100 million)	Rate	High-range	Arrests with a blood specimen, 2025	At .15 or more	Injury crashes, drinking driver, 2025
Aldous	32	61.57	0.52	No	171	45.6%	27
Brisbin	59	109.27	0.54	No	377	64.7%	79
Corwin	60	84.55	0.71	Yes	246	45.1%	58
Delmont	79	154.94	0.51	No	385	50.1%	76
Fairlee	90	200.37	0.45	No	429	46.4%	77
Hatchell	85	124.82	0.68	Yes	371	49.9%	78
Keswick	78	229.80	0.34	No	574	47.4%	123
Kittredge	43	75.69	0.57	No	206	43.7%	29
Lanier	51	94.92	0.54	No	275	56.0%	29
Ossian	54	79.63	0.68	Yes	224	47.3%	43
Pruett	102	185.31	0.55	No	415	61.7%	119
Renwick	67	175.73	0.38	No	409	47.9%	90
Stroud	57	139.69	0.41	No	341	51.0%	68
Tanager	66	99.91	0.66	Yes	454	32.4%	105

Sources: Fatal Crash Census, 2023, 2024 and 2025 files; DOT county daily vehicle miles 2023 to 2025; State Toxicology Laboratory specimen extract of 12 March 2027; Crash Records System extract of 8 March 2027.

Deaths are the number expected from the census records under guidelines 2.2, rounded to whole deaths; each rate is computed from the unrounded count and compared with 0.60 before rounding. Vehicle miles are the DOT's daily miles times 365 days, 366 in 2024.

The baselines in Table 1 are the three section 3.1 figures each task force application states: the county's 2025 impaired-driving arrests with a blood specimen at the laboratory and the per cent of them at .15 or more, and its 2025 injury crashes in which no one died within 30 days and an officer reported a driver had been drinking.

Sincerely,

Mary Mitchell
Impaired Driving Program Coordinator, Center for Transportation Safety

cc: Eduardo Chapman, Crash Records Manager